maintenance and time in port. These include regions from the Gulf of Aden to the west to the Strait of Malacca in the east where the Indian Navy attempts to have at least one surface vessel, submarine or aircraft deployed any given time. Moreover, the Navy now operates at a higher state of readiness, with weapons and relief supplies. This has proved useful in contingencies such as anti-piracy operations and humanitarian disasters. [28]

Bilateral agreements for logistics—as with the United States, France, and Australia—and the establishment of operational turnaround points in arrangements with countries such as Oman and Indonesia, have helped extend the Navy's operational reach. In part, India has benefited from greater maritime domain awareness, the ability to track civilian, military and non-state vessels at sea. This includes surveillance through coastal radar networks extending across the Bay of Bengal and into the central Indian Ocean, as well as satellite capabilities. To integrate that information, India established an information fusion centre in Gurugram called the Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR), which hosts liaison officers from friendly partner countries. Several bilateral 'white shipping' agreements have helped to facilitate information sharing with partners as well. Cooperation on anti-submarine warfare remains sensitive but important, with considerable room for improvement.

While China has been investing in port infrastructure throughout the Indian Ocean region, India has invested in a parallel architecture, including civilian ports in Sittwe in Myanmar and a container port at Chabahar in Iran. It has also invested in maritime infrastructure in Sri Lanka, the Maldives, and Mauritius, while in other cases it has worked to ensure greater transparency and access to Chinese-financed facilities so as to ameliorate security concerns. In places like Mauritius and the Seychelles, India has tried to deepen its partnerships, supplying both with coast guard equipment (including aircraft and patrol vessels), patrolling their waters using ships and naval aircraft, and involving them in coast guard and maritime domain awareness efforts. [29] Using its newfound capabilities, partners and deployment patterns, India has also been playing a more active role in humanitarian assistance and disaster relief operation all around the